

Most of our end-users usually start with a minimum configuration and keep scaling the cluster when they have the money," explains Ranganath.

T-Platforms power

The recent partnership with T-Platforms has, however, helped Digital Waves take its high computing capabilities to the next level. "We did not have a high-end blade server product among our offerings. Also, we didn't have the experience and expertise to build a multi-teraflop cluster. Through our association with T-Platforms, Russia, we are able to offer all these products," says Ranganath.

"T-Platforms' high performance solutions achieve equivalence both in terms of productivity and fault tolerance with top brand names, while boasting the best price/performance ratio on the market. We strongly believe that these offerings are not available with other biggies, which is the advantage Digital Waves now provides," adds Ranganath.

Since 2003, T-Platforms has implemented over 150 HPC projects. The company has delivered fully integrated high performance cluster solutions to the Moscow State University of MV Lomonosov, the South Ural State University, the Inter-Regional Computing Centre, the Tomsk State University, the Scientific and Research Institute of Epidemiology and Microbiology of RAMS, and many other organisations. The firm's 'Lomonosov' supercomputer, which is ranked 12th among the current Top 500 supercomputers in the world, consists of 4,446 nodes, 8,840 quad-core Intel Xeon processors, 52 multi-core PowerXCell 8i processors, and InfiniBand interconnects, all of which add up to give a peak performance of 420 Tflops. Further, the systems of the T-Blade family developed by T-Platforms are used as computing nodes by Russia's third-most powerful supercomputer.

Digital Waves offers T-Platforms' latest products in India, which include the blade systems T-Blade 1.1 and T-Blade 2.0; PeakCell S, a server based on 9-core PowerXCell 8i processors, and Clustrx software for high-performance computing systems.

The T-Blade family

The T-Blade 1.1 system chassis incorporates the computing power of 20 quad-core Intel Xeon 55xx processors or six-core AMD Opteron 24xx processors in a compact 5U enclosure, to give up to 9.98 Tflops of peak performance in a standard 42U rack. T-Blade 2.0, on the other hand, is specially designed for building compute systems with petascale levels of performance. T-Blade 2.0 provides a peak performance of up to 3 Tflops in a 7U enclosure, and up to 18 Tflops in a standard 42U rack.

Clustrx

Further, Digital Waves can now offer the Clustrx software for high performance computing systems,

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which can help improve utilisation of computing power and ensure better manageability of supercomputing systems of different sizes, from 'personal clusters' to petascale systems. "We can now offer Clustrx, a software stack for high-performance computing developed as the ultimate middleware between a supercomputer platform and an end-user application. Most of Clustrx has been programmed from scratch to eliminate critical limitations of legacy management and monitoring systems (like Nagios, Ganglia, Torque, etc), and to create a simple yet reliable environment for supercomputer access," elaborates Ranganath.

Digital Waves is an exclusive regional representative and authorised partner of T-Platforms. It also takes care of installation and maintenance of systems based on T-Platform solutions, ensuring complete support is provided to the customer. "We are currently working with several research organisations, defence and corporate establishments for their HPC cluster solutions," says Ranganath.

Road ahead

Looking ahead, Digital Waves plans to pave the way for HPC in India. "Our vision is to become a leading HPC cluster solutions provider for R&D/academic institutions, defence set-ups and corporations in India. We want to actively market our brand 'Power-X HPC Clusters', which are based on the latest x86 and emerging technologies. Also, we will promote T-Blade-based HPC clusters," says Ranganath. "Our partnership with T-Platforms has set the ball rolling."

Ranganath signs off by thanking the many scientists from the IISc/IITs and various other organisations, who have given him an opportunity to work with them for their HPC projects. 

By: Vanisha Joseph

The author loves to experiment and writing for LINUX For You is her latest experiment. So, beware! Just a minute, she also happens to be a journalist during the day.